Google System Design Interview Survival Guide

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Technical Interview Process at Google

1



Online application
The first step is to apply online for one of the available roles of your interest

2



Resume screening
An initial review to assess alignment with requirements

3



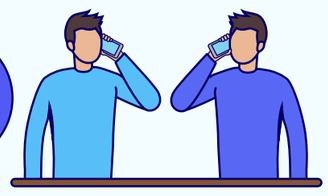
Recruiter call
A brief call to discuss role expectations and background

4



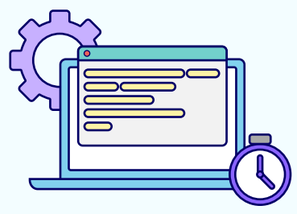
Online assessments
Assessments to measure work style and technical skills

5



Technical phone screen
A remote coding or technical assessment

6



Project work
Project work to assess problem-solving skills

7



Virtual or on-site interview loops
In-depth technical (coding and System Design) and behavioral rounds (3–4)

8



Hiring committee review
A panel evaluates the candidate's overall performance

9



Decision and offer
The final decision and offer are extended to the candidate

!



Process duration: 6 - 12 weeks
Interview duration: 45 - 60 minutes each
How many interviews to expect: 5 - 6 interviews

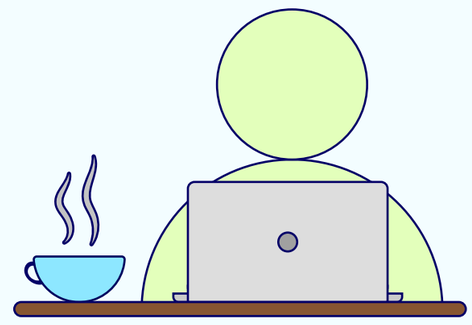
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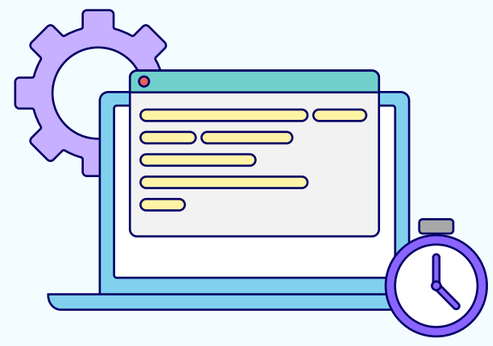
System Design Interview Process at Google



The interviewer asks the candidate to design a system



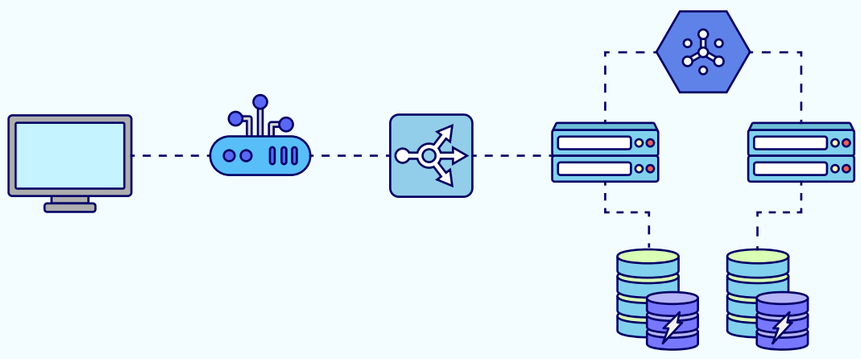
The candidate understands the requirements and asks clarifying questions



The candidate determines the scope by defining all the features



The candidate presents a high-level design, storage schema, and APIs



The candidate outlines the detailed design



Discuss design choices, evaluate trade-offs, and iterate design

Interview duration: 45 - 60 minutes each

Top 10 System Design Interview Problems Asked at Google

- Design Google Maps
- Design Uber
- Design a Typeahead
- Design YouTube Service
- Design a Messaging App
- Design a Newsfeed
- Design Google Docs
- Design TinyURL
- Design a Web Crawler
- Design a Chess Game

Hacking the Google Interview

Google Interview Tips

- Strengthen data structures and algorithms.
- For behavioral questions, utilize the STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) approach to answer.
- Prioritize customers while answering interview questions.
- Good communication is essential; be confident and provide a clear thought process.
- Manage your time.
- Show curiosity and ask genuine questions.

System Design Interview Mistakes to Avoid

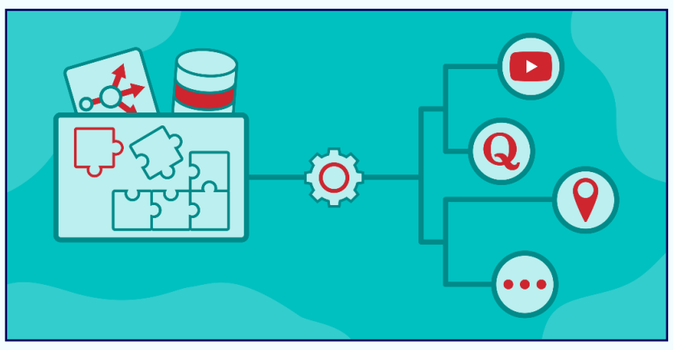
- Failing to understand functional and nonfunctional requirements.
- Not estimating required resources (back-of-the-envelope calculations).
- Overlooking failure points and recovery strategies.
- Failing to consider the tradeoffs for different solutions.
- Under-communication or over-communication.
- No justifications for design decisions.
- Skipping the high-level design.

Note: At Google, each interviewer rates candidates and gives recommendations such as strong no hire, no hire, leaning no hire, leaning hire, hire, and strong hire.

Related Courses

To learn more about system and product architecture design, you can explore the following courses:

Grokking the Modern System Design Interview



Grokking the Product Architecture Design Interview

